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File No.: EXP202308911

RESOLUTION OF SANCTIONING PROCEDURE

From the procedure initiated by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection and based on the following

BACKGROUND

FIRST: As a result of a complaint filed with the Spanish Agency for Data Protection against A.A.A. with NIF ***NIF.1 (hereinafter, the complained party), and noting indications of a possible breach of the regulations within the scope of the competencies of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection, actions were initiated under file number EXP202303746.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on Personal Data Protection and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter, LOPDGDD), the complaint was forwarded to the responsible party or the Data Protection Officer designated, if applicable, requesting them to send this Agency the information and documentation indicated. This request for information was not answered within the stipulated time. The complaint was accepted for processing on May 15, 2023.

SECOND: The General Sub-Directorate for Data Inspection proceeded to carry out preliminary investigative actions to clarify the facts in question, by virtue of the investigative powers granted to control authorities under Article 57.1 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and in accordance with the provisions established in Title VII, Chapter I, Section Two, of the aforementioned LOPDGDD.

In the framework of the investigative actions, three requests for information were sent to the complained party, related to the complaint mentioned in the first section, asking them to present before this Agency the information and documentation specified within ten working days. The requests for information were registered as sent on May 24, 2023, and June 7 and 8, 2023.

THIRD: The requests for information, which were notified in accordance with the rules established in Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations (hereinafter, LPACAP), were received by the complained party, as evidenced by the acknowledgments of receipt in the file.

FOURTH: Regarding the requested information, the complained party has not submitted any response to this Spanish Agency for Data Protection.

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FIFTH: On July 12, 2023, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection decided to initiate sanctioning proceedings against the complained party for the alleged infringement of Article 58.1 of the GDPR, classified under Article 83.5 of the GDPR.

SIXTH: The aforementioned initiation agreement was notified in accordance with the rules established in the LPACAP, and after the period granted for the submission of allegations had elapsed, it was confirmed that no allegations had been received from the complained party.

Article 64.2.f) of the LPACAP - a provision of which the complained party was informed in the initiation agreement - establishes that if no allegations are made within the stipulated period regarding the content of the initiation agreement, when it contains a precise statement regarding the responsibility attributed, it may be considered a proposal for resolution. In this case, the initiation agreement of the sanctioning file determined the facts on which the accusation was based, the infringement of the GDPR attributed to the complained party, and the sanction that could be imposed. Therefore, considering that the complained party has not made allegations against the initiation agreement of the file and in accordance with the provisions established in Article 64.2.f) of the LPACAP, the aforementioned initiation agreement is considered in this case as a proposal for resolution.

In view of all that has been acted upon by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection in this procedure,

the following facts are considered proven,

PROVEN FACTS

FIRST: The requests for information indicated in the first, second, and third backgrounds were notified in accordance with the provisions of the LPACAP.

SECOND: The complained party has not responded to the requests for information made by this Agency within the timeframes granted for this purpose in the context of the investigative actions of file EXP202303746.

THIRD: The initiation agreement of this sanctioning procedure was notified to the complained party in accordance with the provisions of the LPACAP on July 13, 2023.

FOURTH: The complained party has not submitted allegations to the initiation agreement of this sanctioning procedure.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each control authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, 64.2, and 68.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on Personal Data Protection and Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter, LOPDGDD), it is competent to

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to initiate and resolve this procedure the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states that: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued in its development, and, to the extent that they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

II

Unfulfilled Obligation

In accordance with the available evidence, it is considered that the respondent has not provided the information requested by the Spanish Agency for Data Protection.

With the aforementioned conduct of the respondent, the investigative power conferred to control authorities by Article 58.1 of the GDPR, in this case, the AEPD, has been obstructed.

Therefore, the facts described in the section "Proven Facts" are deemed to constitute an infringement, attributable to the respondent, for violation of Article 58.1 of the GDPR, which states that each control authority shall have, among its investigative powers:

"a) to order the controller and the processor and, where applicable, the representative of the controller or the processor, to provide any information required for the performance of its functions; b) to carry out investigations in the form of data protection audits; c) to carry out a review of the certifications issued under Article 42, paragraph 7; d) to notify the controller or the processor of the alleged infringements of this Regulation; e) to obtain from the controller and the processor access to all personal data and to all information necessary for the exercise of its functions; f) to obtain access to all premises of the controller and the processor, including any equipment and means of processing data, in accordance with the procedural law of the Union or of the Member States."

III

Classification and Qualification of the Infringement

In accordance with the available evidence, the facts presented are deemed to constitute an infringement, attributable to the respondent.

This infringement is classified under Article 83.5.e) of the GDPR, which considers as such: "not providing access in violation of Article 58, paragraph 1."

The same article establishes that this infringement may be sanctioned with a fine of up to twenty million euros (€20,000,000) or, in the case of a company, an amount equivalent to four percent (4%) of the total annual global turnover of the previous financial year, opting for the higher amount.

For the purposes of the statute of limitations for infringements, the infringement attributed prescribes after three years, in accordance with Article 72.1 of the LOPDGDD, which classifies the following conduct as very serious:

“ñ) Not providing access to the competent data protection authority's personnel to personal data, information, premises, equipment, and means of processing that are required by the data protection authority for the exercise of its investigative powers.

o) The resistance or obstruction of the exercise of the inspection function by the competent data protection authority.”

IV

Imposed Sanction

The fine imposed must be, in each individual case, effective, proportionate, and dissuasive, in accordance with the provisions of Article 83.1 of the GDPR. Consequently, the sanction to be imposed must be graduated according to the criteria established in Article 83.2 of the GDPR, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 76 of the LOPDGDD, regarding section k) of the aforementioned Article 83.2 GDPR.

It is noted that no mitigating or aggravating factors apply.

In light of the facts presented, it is considered appropriate to impose a sanction on the respondent for the violation of Article 58.1 of the GDPR classified under Article 83.5 e) of the GDPR. The sanction to be imposed is an administrative fine of €200.00 (TWO HUNDRED euros).

Therefore, in accordance with the applicable legislation, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO IMPOSE on A.A.A., with NIF ***NIF.1, for an infringement of Article 58.1 of the GDPR, classified under Article 83.5 of the GDPR, a fine of €200.00 (TWO HUNDRED euros).

SECOND: TO ORDER A.A.A. that, in accordance with the investigative power provided in Article 58.1.a) of the GDPR, the requested information be provided within ten working days, as required in the requests made in the context of the proceedings numbered EXP202303746 and referenced in the background of this resolution.

It is warned that failure to comply with the requests of this agency may be considered an administrative infringement in accordance with the provisions of the GDPR, classified as an infringement in its Article 83.6, which may lead to the initiation of further administrative sanctioning proceedings.

THIRD: TO NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A.

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FOURTH: This resolution shall be enforceable once the period for filing the optional appeal for reconsideration (one month from the day following the notification of this resolution) has expired without the interested party having exercised this right. The sanctioned party is warned that they must comply with the imposed sanction once this resolution becomes enforceable, in accordance with the provisions of Article 98.1.b) of Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations (hereinafter LPACAP), within the voluntary payment period established in Article 68 of the General Collection Regulation, approved by Royal Decree 939/2005, of July 29, in relation to Article 62 of Law 58/2003, of December 17, by making the payment, indicating the NIF of the sanctioned party and the procedure number that appears in the heading of this document, into the restricted account No. IBAN: ES00 0000 0000 0000 0000 (BIC/SWIFT Code: XXXXXXXXXXXX), opened in the name of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection at the banking entity CAIXABANK, S.A. Otherwise, collection will proceed in the executive period.

Upon receipt of the notification and once enforceable, if the date of enforceability falls between the 1st

and the 15th of each month, inclusive, the deadline for making the voluntary payment will be until the 20th of the following month or the next business day thereafter, and if it falls between the 16th and the last day of each month, inclusive, the payment deadline will be until the 5th of the second following month or the next business day thereafter.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure in accordance with Article 48.6 of the LOPDGDD, and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of the LPACAP, the interested parties may optionally file an appeal for reconsideration before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution or directly file a contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and paragraph 5 of the fourth additional provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating the Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned Law. Finally, it is noted that in accordance with the provisions of Article 90.3 a) of the LPACAP, the firm resolution in the administrative procedure may be provisionally suspended if the interested party expresses their intention to file a contentious-administrative appeal. If this is the case, the interested party must formally communicate this fact by means of a written document addressed to the Spanish Agency for Data Protection, submitting it through the Electronic Registry of the Agency [<https://sedeagpd.gob.es/sede-electronica-web/>], or through any of the other registries provided for in Article 16.4 of Law 39/2015, of October 1. They must also provide the Agency with documentation that proves the effective filing of the contentious-administrative appeal. If the Agency is not aware of the filing of the contentious-administrative appeal within two months from the day following the notification of this resolution, it will consider the provisional suspension to be concluded.

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Mar España Martí

Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection

C/ Jorge Juan, 6

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